4 Defining and illustrating features

This chapter covers

- Describing and organizing features and user stories
- Illustrating features with examples
- Using these examples to build up a common understanding of the requirements

In the previous chapter you learned how important it is to understand why you're building a piece of software and what its ultimate purpose will be in business terms. We looked at how you can clarify *what* you want to achieve and *how* you expect this to benefit the business (the business goals), and also at *who* will benefit or be affected by the project (the stakeholders) and *what* you need to deliver at a high level to achieve the business goals (the capabilities).

Now it's time to describe *how* you can provide these capabilities. In this chapter we'll learn about what BDD practitioners often refer to as features, and about some of the techniques they use to describe and discuss these features (see figure 4.1):

- In BDD terms, a *feature* is a piece of software functionality that helps users or other stakeholders achieve some business goal. A feature is not a user story, but it can be described by one or several user stories.